

The Noble Perfection of Wisdom, Vajrapāṇi, Great Vehicle Sūtra

Ārya-prajñāpāramitā-vajrapāṇi-mahāyāna-sūtra · Toh 29 · Derge Kangyur

འཕགས་པ་ཤེས་རབ་ཀྱི་རྩོད་ཕྱི་ཐུག་པ་ལག་

Toh 29 in the Kangyur is a Mahāyāna sūtra known in English as the Noble Perfection of Wisdom, Vajrapāṇi Sūtra, in Sanskrit as the Ārya-prajñāpāramitā-vajrapāṇi-mahāyāna-sūtra, and in Tibetan as Phags pa shes rab kyi pha rol tu phyin pa lag na rdo rje theg pa chen po'i mdo. It belongs to the Perfection of Wisdom class of texts and is set at Rājagṛha, where the bodhisattva Vajrapāṇi poses questions to the Buddha about how a bodhisattva should train in the Perfection of Wisdom. The Buddha's central teaching in response is that such training rests on understanding all phenomena as without arising. The text immediately follows Toh 28, the Noble Samantabhadra Great Vehicle Sūtra, and together these short sūtras form part of the broader Prajñāpāramitā section of the Kangyur.

They joyfully praised what the Blessed One had declared. The Noble Samantabhadra Great Vehicle Sūtra is complete.

In the language of India: Ārya-prajñāpāramitā-vajrapāṇi-mahāyāna-sūtra. In the Tibetan language: The Noble Perfection of Wisdom, Vajrapāṇi, Great Vehicle Sūtra.

Homage to all buddhas and bodhisattvas.

Thus did I hear. At one time the Blessed One was dwelling at Rājagṛha. At that time, the bodhisattva Vajrapāṇi was present in that assembly. He rose from his seat and addressed the Blessed One with these words: "Blessed One, how should a bodhisattva train in the Perfection of Wisdom?"

The Blessed One declared: "Vajrapāṇi, a bodhisattva should train in the Perfection of Wisdom in this way: by understanding that all phenomena are without arising, one should train in the Perfection of Wisdom. Furthermore, because all phenomena — form and the rest — are without intrinsic nature, without distinguishing marks, devoid of things, and unapprehendable, one should train in the Perfection of Wisdom. Because of inner emptiness and the emptiness of non-existence of things, one should train in the Perfection of Wisdom.

"Vajrapāṇi, this Perfection of Wisdom is the mother of all buddhas of the three times. The words of the mantra of great knowledge-awareness are these: tadyathā — oṃ mune mune mahāmunaye svāhā.

"Whoever holds to this Perfection of Wisdom will come to grasp the Dharma of all the buddhas of the three times. They will come to remember their births. They will abandon all states of lack of leisure. They will attain the fruit of merit beyond measure. They will always dwell in the company of the blessed buddhas. They will come to be endowed with the awakening mind."

When the Blessed One had declared this, the bodhisattva Vajrapāṇi, along with the gods, humans, asuras, and gandharvas — the whole world — rejoiced and praised what the Blessed One had declared.

Translator's Notes

- The passage opens with the closing colophon of a preceding text, the Noble Samantabhadra Great Vehicle Sūtra, and then immediately begins the title and opening of a separate text, the Ārya-prajñāpāramitā-vajrapāṇi-mahāyāna-sūtra. The two texts appear consecutively in the same manuscript block without a hard break, which is standard in canonical collections. The mantra is rendered phonetically as it appears in the Tibetan transliteration. The phrase "states of lack of leisure" renders the Tibetan *mi khom pa*, the standard term for the eight conditions unfavorable to Dharma practice.

Colophon

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Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.